



Build an HA Stateful Fail-over Firewall Cluster on Linux

This article shows you how to configure a highly available (HA) stateful firewall cluster that will meet all your needs for a modern firewall infrastructure. The components of the cluster are the Linux OS, iptables, conntrackd, keepalived, and fwbuilder to manage the policies. All the components used here are open source, which means you don't have to pay a single penny to build your stateful firewall cluster

Every network security administrator's dream is to have a highly available firewall that will not allow a single point of failure in a crucial network.

There are so many commercial products currently available in the market that can fulfil this requirement, and they work very well—but how about the cost factor? What if your organisation doesn't have that big a budget

allocated for infrastructure? What if your management doesn't want to pay a hefty amount for firewall licences? The answer lies here...

What is a stateful fail-over HA firewall?

According to the wiki, a stateful firewall is one that keeps track of the state of network connections (such as TCP streams, UDP